



Cashews

The major export of Guinea-Bissau is cashew nuts, the seeds of the cashew tree.

Cashew seed



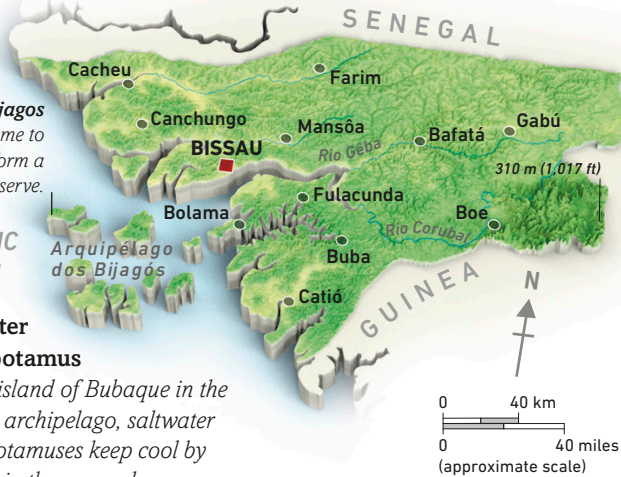
The 88 islands of **Bijagos Archipelago**, home to a rich wildlife, form a protected nature reserve.

Saltwater hippopotamus

Saltwater hippopotamus

On the island of Bubaque in the Bijagos archipelago, saltwater hippopotamuses keep cool by wading in the sea and swamps.

Guinea-Bissau



Bissau

A busy port in the vast Geba River estuary, Bissau was founded in 1687. The statue in front of the presidential palace is dedicated to heroes of the independence.



- 📏 13,948 sq miles (36,125 sq km)
- 👤 1.9 million
- ★ Bissau
- 🗣️ Portuguese Creole, Balante, other languages (+3)

Most of this small West African nation is a **low-lying flood plain**, with tides reaching far inland. Its **estuary landscape** is lush with **mangroves** and **national parks**. Half of the population lives along the coast.

Guinea



Western green mamba

Spending most of its time in the trees of Guinea's forests, this agile snake is shy but moves fast, and its venom is deadly.



- 📏 94,926 sq miles (245,857 sq km)
- 👤 12.5 million
- ★ Conakry
- 🗣️ Pulaar, Malinké, Soussou, French



Gold deposits

The many gold mines in northeast Guinea, near Siguiri, produce about 16.5 tons (15 metric tons) of gold every year.

Conakry

On a long, narrow peninsula, the capital, Conakry, has a large cargo port as well as a smaller harbor full of colorful fishing boats.



Guinea's landscape ranges from inland **savanna** to **coastal mangroves**, and **22 rivers** have their sources in its mountains. It is rich in **bauxite** (a source of aluminum) and **gold**, but most people are vegetable farmers.